

N07 NUTRITION EDUCATION | O (MAX : 1 PT)

Intent : Support a healthy eating pattern by increasing nutritional knowledge and food literacy.

Summary :
This WELL feature requires the provision of nutrition education.

Issue : Food literacy is defined as an individual's ability to not only understand nutrition information but also to implement this knowledge into their diet through preparation and cooking of food and healthy meals.¹ Studies report a positive relationship between food literacy levels and healthy dietary intake. Unfortunately, due to a global dietary shift away from whole ingredient foods, such as fruits and vegetables, and towards highly processed foods that require little-to-no skill in preparation and cooking, many people lack adequate food literacy to make healthy choices.² Therefore, nutrition and food education programs focused on increasing levels of food literacy are important to individual health and well-being. Participation in food and nutrition education programs have been associated with increased fruit and vegetable intake, knowledge of food preparation skills, and improvements in healthy behaviors.³⁻⁷

Solutions : Nutrition education has been shown to be more effective when focused on changing specific behaviors, rather than only increasing knowledge.^{8,9} Nutrition education is also more effective when combined with environmental dietary modifications, such as strategic placement of healthier alternatives, portion size control and menu modifications.³ Educational programming that includes multiple types of interventions (mixed-method programming) and that is on-going or longer term has a greater impact than short-term, single-method interventions.^{3,5} The scope of nutrition and food education may also be broader than personal nutrition and health. For example, education can cover topics, such as safe food handling practices, gardening and food production techniques, as well as food preparation skills.

PART 1 PROVIDE NUTRITION EDUCATION (MAX : 1 PT)

For All Spaces:

At least one of the following is offered live (in-person or virtually) to regular occupants at no cost on a quarterly basis at minimum:

- a. Cooking demonstrations led by chef-instructors that include fruits and/or vegetables, demonstrate cooking skills and integrate hands-on learning opportunities.
- b. Nutrition or dietary education sessions led by an accredited dietitian or accredited nutritionist.
- c. Individual nutrition consultations led by an accredited dietitian or accredited nutritionist.
- d. Gardening or planting workshops focused on edible plants that integrate hands-on learning opportunities.

REFERENCES

1. Vaitkeviciute R, Ball LE, Harris N. The relationship between food literacy and dietary intake in adolescents: A systematic review. *Public Health Nutr.* 2015;18(4):649-658. doi:10.1017/S1368980014000962
2. Douwes J, Thorne P, Pearce N, Heederik D. Bioaerosol health effects and exposure assessment: Progress and prospects. *Ann Occup Hyg.* 2003;47(3):187-200. doi:10.1093/annhyg/meg032
3. Geaney F, Kelly C, Di Marrazzo JS, et al. The effect of complex workplace dietary interventions on employees' dietary intakes, nutrition knowledge and health status: A cluster controlled trial. *Prev Med (Baltim).* 2016;89:76-83. doi:10.1016/j.ypmed.2016.05.005
4. Long Valerie, Cates Sheryl, Blitstein Jonathan, et al. Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program Education and Evaluation Study (Wave II). 2013. <https://fns-prod.azureedge.net/sites/default/files/SNAPedWaveII.pdf>.
5. Pem D, Jeewon R. Fruit and Vegetable Intake: Benefits and Progress of Nutrition Education Interventions- Narrative Review Article. *Iran J Public Health.* 2015;44(10):1309-1321.
6. Reicks M et al. Impact of cooking and home food preparation interventions among adults: A systematic review (2011-2016). *J Nutr Educ Behav.* 2018;50(2):148-172.
7. Goh LML, Wong AX, Ang GY, Tan ASL. Effectiveness of nutrition education accompanied by cooking demonstration. *Br Food J.* 2017;119(5):1052-1066. doi:10.1108/BFJ-10-2016-0464
8. Murimi MW, Kanyi M, Mupfudze T, Amin M, Mbogori T, Aldubayan K. Factors Influencing Efficacy of Nutrition Education Interventions: A Systematic Review. *J Nutr Educ Behav.* 2017;49(2):142-165.e1. doi:10.1016/j.jneb.2016.09.003
9. Murimi MW, Moyeda-Carabaza AF, Nguyen B, Saha S, Amin R, Njike V. Factors that contribute to effective nutrition education interventions in children: a systematic review. *Nutr Rev.* 2018;76(8):553-580. doi:10.1093/nutrit/nuy020